John T. Zink

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Profile

Mechanical engineering undergraduate at Colorado State University and Honors Program student with hands-on experience in mechanical design, manufacturing, process development, and automotive systems. Experienced with SolidWorks, additive manufacturing, and machining with a strong interest in mechanical design.

Skills

CAD and Programming: Design experience and CSWA certification using SolidWorks to build automotive and CNC models, as well as 3D printable files. Programming exposure to C++ and Java with more experience in MATLAB, HTML, and CSS

Manufacturing: Familiarity with manual mill and lathe, as well as their CNC counterparts through the Haas CNC mill certificate. Experience using low power and CO2 laser engraving and cutting.

Automotive restoration: Build custom parts, weld, and work with combustion engines, drivetrain, and electronics of 1970s Volkswagen Beetles.

Technical skills: Reading and making lighting diagrams, wiring diagrams, scale drawings, and 3D renderings for theatre and manufacturing purposes.

Education

Colorado State University / B.S. Mechanical Engineering, Honors Program

August 2024 - Current

4.0 GPA up to this point as a first-semester Junior with technical classes such as mechatronics, thermodynamics, dynamics, statics, and design passed with As.

Experience

Creation Technologies / Engineering Intern

Summer 2025 and 2026, Albuquerque, NM

Assisted process and manufacturing engineers with a primary focus on SolidWorks design, FDM and resin 3D printing, as well as general maintenance of the surface mount PCB line.

Led a manufacturing team in developing and implementing a new process for resin-printed connector boots, including product design, testing and iteration, post-processing procedure development, process documentation, and training existing employees to established quality standards.

Cost savings analysis showed a 222 hour reduction in labor and $225,000 total savings.

Waterfall Ranch / Ranch Hand

May 2020 - June 2024, Durango, CO

Worked as available, helping restore wetlands by operating heavy machinery, monitoring the biodiversity of wildlife, and maintaining/fixing equipment.

Outpost Ice Arenas / Coach

May 2022 - July 2024, Albuquerque, NM

Began as a volunteer helping coach young kids then was offered a job in 2023 to continue coaching summer development camps for kids under 10 and “learn to play hockey” outreach programs.